

Product Spec: Business Loan Application Portal

Meridian Commercial Bank - Internal Document

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Overview

The Business Loan Application Portal allows small-business customers to apply for, track, and (upon approval) receive disbursement of a business loan entirely online, replacing the current branch-only application process.

Goals

- Reduce average time-to-decision from 10 business days (branch process) to 2 business days for loans under \$250,000.
- Provide applicants with real-time status visibility instead of requiring phone follow-up.

Requirements

1. Application intake: business financials, ownership information, and requested loan amount/purpose, with document upload for supporting materials (tax returns, financial statements).
2. Automated pre-screening: a rules-based check (credit score threshold, debt-to-income ratio, business age) runs immediately on submission; applications failing pre-screening are routed to manual review rather than auto-declined, to avoid false negatives on edge cases.
3. Underwriting queue: applications passing pre-screening enter a underwriter review queue with SLA tracking (target: 2 business days for loans under \$250,000; 5 business days above that threshold).
4. Disbursement: upon approval, funds are disbursed via the ACH Batch Processor (see ARCH-payments-platform-overview) into the business's designated Meridian account, or an external account via standard ACH if the business does not hold a Meridian deposit account.
5. Status tracking: applicants see one of Submitted, Pre-Screening, Under Review, Approved, Declined, Disbursed at each stage.

Dependencies

- ACH Batch Processor for disbursement (subject to the same batch-window and capacity-planning considerations noted in INC-2025-12-19-003; large disbursement batches around month-end should be flagged to Payments Platform in advance).

Open Questions

- Should pre-approved existing customers get an expedited underwriting path? Under discussion with Underwriting leadership, not yet decided for v1.
- Loan servicing (payments, statements) is handled by a separate existing system and is explicitly out of scope for this portal.